Financial Literacy for Kids

Module 1 Study Guide

What Is Money?

This guide covers every lesson of the module, using only words and figures from the lessons themselves. Work through it after watching the lessons, then use the checklist at the end to test yourself.

Lesson 1: The Barter Days: Swapping Milk for Hammers

In this lesson: Learn about barter; See why swapping is confusing; Discover how money helps.

Key points

- Barter means swapping goods directly
- Swapping can be confusing without agreement
- Money gives a common value

Examples from the lesson

- He likes milk, but he wonders how much milk equals one hammer. Maybe two jugs? Maybe half a jug? They try to agree, but it is hard.
- He wants a fishing rod from Nina. Sam offers three potatoes for the rod. Nina says she needs five potatoes to feel fair.
- One cow might be worth ten sheep to one farmer, but only five sheep to another.

Hero mission (try it with a parent)

With a parent, look at three items in your home and talk about how many of one you would trade for another. Write down your ideas and see if you both agree. Have fun discovering the value of things!

Lesson 2: Coins, Kings, and Paper Promises

In this lesson: Bronze coins start; Gold is heavy; Banks make paper notes.

Key points

- Bronze coins are light
- Gold coins are heavy
- Paper notes stand for gold

Examples from the lesson

- The coins are light. I pick one up. It feels cool in my palm.

Hero mission (try it with a parent)

With a parent, find a coin at home. Feel its weight. Then draw a picture of a paper note you could use to buy a maxi. Show your drawing to a grown-up and talk about why the paper is easier to carry than a gold coin.

Lesson 3: Cards, Phones, and Money Today

In this lesson: Magic Taps; The Bank Chest; Future Money.

Key points

- Cards send fast messages to banks
- Money moves as safe digital numbers
- Online shopping sends money across the world

Examples from the lesson

- The message says, "Please move five dollars from this family to the shop."
- If the money is there, it moves the numbers in less than two seconds!

Hero mission (try it with a parent)

Ask a parent to show you a plastic card or a payment app on a phone. Ask them where the secret message goes when they tap it. You are officially a money master!

Recap checklist — can you say each one?

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Lesson 2: Coins, Kings, and Paper Promises

- ☐ Bronze coins are light
- ☐ Gold coins are heavy
- ☐ Paper notes stand for gold

Lesson 3: Cards, Phones, and Money Today

- ☐ Cards send fast messages to banks
- ☐ Money moves as safe digital numbers
- ☐ Online shopping sends money across the world